

NIFTY TOOLS AND WEB APPLICATIONS FOR WEB DESIGNERS

- **Are my site up:** This tool helps you to check at one glance if all your servers are up and running <http://aremysitesup.com/>
- **Firebug:** An add-on for Firefox browser which allows you to inspect, edit and monitor CSS, HTML, JavaScript and Net requests in any web page. <http://getfirebug.com/>
- **FontExplorer X Pro:** This works like a suitcase for fonts – a very useful companion www.fontexplorerx.com
- **ClueApp:** The tool helps you answer questions like – which page are the users spending the most time at? <http://www.clueapp.com/>
- **Kuler:** A web hosted application that generates colour themes www.kuler.adobe.com

Apple, BlackBerry and Android. Mayank has been developing websites since he was in ninth grade and believes in the concept of self-learning and says that, “learning never ends.” If there’s a conclusive example that mainstream success does not always equate with formal education, this is it.

At a crossroad – Freelance or Employment?

Eventually, at some point in time, not only a web designer but almost all professionals have to choose which road they want to go down: a freelancer picking up his own projects or a fully employed professional with a firm. Freelancers typically need to work on a strong portfolio if they expect to find decent work. Since you’re not

backed by a brand as a freelancer, the onus lies on you to build your own personal brand and market yourself online. A strong social media presence is obviously your best option in this regard. The advantages of working as a freelancer include the freedom to choose your work and set your own timelines; you may find yourself with more spare time which you can use to level-up yourself. The disadvantages are, or rather some things that you should keep in mind are: working as a freelancer requires a lot of self-discipline, it is only too easy to lay back and watch a movie instead of working and then there’s the lack of stability.

One of the cons of being employed is that you have no control over which projects you get to work on, something creative people typically have a problem with. The advantages are quite apparent too: you’re assured of a consistent source of income; you’re still “in the game”, so to speak, and